



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Providence Christian Academy

School Website: <https://providenceca.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Providence Christian Academy (PCA) in 46311 presents a robust classical Christian program. Public-facing materials emphasize a Reformed Christian foundation, classical curriculum, memorization, Great Books-style engagement, Latin, and explicit integration of faith with learning. Pedagogy centers on memory work in the grammar years, Socratic discussion and rhetoric in the upper years, and a strong emphasis on virtue, formation, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. Community elements highlight active partnership with parents and liturgical practices (devotions, hymns/psalms, chapel). Overall, PCA aligns with the Classical rubric across most categories, with particularly strong evidence in religious foundations, purpose/goals, curriculum, pedagogy, and community engagement. The faculty category shows some alignment but with comparatively less explicit public articulation of the "living curriculum" and teacher profiles, yielding a modestly weaker signal there. Aggregate assessment: **CLASSICAL**.

Key insights: - The school explicitly anchors its mission in biblical/theological commitments and Reformed confessional identity, with a parallel emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty, and on liturgical/community practices. This aligns strongly with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) as **CLASSICAL**. - The curriculum is described as classical, with emphasis on the trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), liberal arts, primary texts, Latin, and Great Books-style engagement, which strongly supports Categories 3 (Curriculum) and 4 (Pedagogy) as **CLASSICAL**. - Evidence for Element 5 (Faculty) is present in the relational/mentoring ethos (teacher-parent partnership) but is less explicit about "living curriculum" or a formal faculty archetype, signaling **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** rather than **FULLY CLASSICAL** in that category. - The school's articulation of formation over information and emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and character is substantial, supporting a **CLASSICAL** rating in Element 2 (Purpose and Goal).

Note on sources used: I drew from PCA's public-facing materials in the crawl (including Philosophy of Education, Principal's Pamphlet, and program descriptions) as well as explicit mentions of classical education elements, Great Books orientation, and liturgical/community practices. Relevant passages include references to classical curriculum, Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium concepts, Latin/Greek study, memorization and memory work, Socratic/seminar style upper-level pedagogy, and partnerships with families. See citations to specific files below for supporting evidence.

Citations: - Distinctly Reformed, classical curriculum, Western civilization emphasis, Latin study: PCA home-page/crawl materials. - Public articulation of Reformed confessional basis, biblical worldview, and pursuit of truth, beauty, goodness: Philosophy of Education; Creedal foundations. - Exalt Christ by pursuing truth, beauty, and goodness; Word of God as foundation; integration of faith and learning. - Lower/upper-division pedagogy and Great Books, memory work, and table-based Socratic pedagogy; emphasis on the trivium in curriculum. - Liturgical and communal practices (devotions, singing, chapels) and teacher/parent partnership language. - Specific curricular Overview (Logic School, Omnibus, Latin Alive, NOEO science; classical

progression). - “Three hallmark features of Classical learning” (memory work, logic, rhetoric) and integration with a biblical worldview. - Great Books/primary texts emphasis, classical learning, and virtuous formation in the program description.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PCA presents a distinctly Reformed, confessional Christian identity and explicitly ties education to biblical truth and the Word of God. The philosophy of education emphasizes a foundation in Scripture and Reformed confessions, with the aim to exalt Christ by pursuing truth, beauty, and goodness. - Public materials note liturgical and communal practices (morning devotions, Psalms/hymns, chapels) and a covenantal family/education approach, signaling a liturgical/community dimension to formation. - The school explicitly positions itself as classical Christian, emphasizing integration of faith with all subjects and a worldview anchored in biblical revelation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, God, Word of God, biblical perspective, liturgical practices, devotion, worship, Reformed/confessions, Christ, Great Books (primary texts), memory work, chant/singing (memory work in worships/learners), community worship. - Negative keywords observed: none evident in public materials.

How this rating was determined - The presence of a robust theological foundation, liturgical practices, and explicit pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty supports CLASSICAL. The absence of explicit negative signals (e.g., secular relativism, instrumentalism) reinforces CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: - Distinctly Reformed, classical framework, biblical integration with learning. - “Exalt Christ by pursuing truth, beauty, and goodness” and Word-of-God foundation. - Liturgical/communal practices (devotions, singing, chapels).

Why this rating - The combination of a Reformed/theological foundation, explicit aim toward transcendentals (truth, beauty, goodness), and liturgical practices signals a strong religious/metaphysical basis aligned with classical education philosophy.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on covenantal Christian education and exaltation of Christ through truth, beauty, and goodness, indicating formation of virtue and wisdom as primary goals rather than vocational preparation alone. - The school frames education as formation within a Christian worldview, prioritizing the integration of faith and reason and the cultivation of character and intellect. - Foundation statements declare that the aim of education is not solely information, but formation in truth, goodness, and beauty under a biblical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing, character, moral imagination, love of learning. - Negative keywords observed: None.

How this rating was determined - The materials emphasize formation and virtuous character in alignment with classical aims, not job-prep or utilitarian metrics.

Cited evidence: - “Mission ... to exalt Christ by pursuing truth, beauty, and goodness.” - “Instructs students from a Biblical perspective ... within a confessionally Reformed and classical framework.” - Foundations on truth/beauty/goodness and formation over mere information.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself as classically oriented with a focus on traditional liberal arts, primary texts, and Latin, and emphasizes the study of great cultural works of Western civilization. - Curriculum materials describe three-stage classical pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the “Great Conversation” with Great Books, including memory work and chants. - Specific curricular components include Omnibus I/II (Ancient/Medieval), memory work, theology, Latin, and logic/socratic discussions in upper grades.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Quadrivium (arithmetic/geometry/music/astronomy), Great Books/Great Conversation, primary texts, memory work, Latin/Greek, integration, wonder, formation. - Negative keywords observed: None.

How this rating was determined - Clear alignment with classical curriculum markers: liberal arts framework, Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis, Great Books, and primary texts, plus memory and chant traditions—all characteristic of CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: - Public statement of “classical curriculum,” Latin study, Great Books emphasis. - Description of the three hallmark features of classical learning (memory/chant, logic order, articulation with rhetoric). - Logic School curricular overview (Omnibus, memory work, Latin, etc.).

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical approach includes a grammar stage (memorization, chants), and then logic and rhetoric (Socratic discussion, seminars, debates) with opportunities to practice rhetoric and public speaking. The public materials discuss teaching methods that align with the trivium and rhetoric training in upper grades. - Lower school activities emphasize singing, chants, and memory as memory-reinforcing, delightful learning, while upper school emphasizes Socratic discussion and rigorous logic and rhetoric training. - The school explicitly mentions Socratic discussions and “table” dialogues to challenge students with ideas from great minds, indicating a move toward classical seminar-style pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: grammar, logic, rhetoric, memory work, chants, songs, Socratic discussions, seminars, debates, rhetoric training, great conversation, table discussions. - Negative keywords observed: None.

How this rating was determined - The pedagogy maps directly to classical pedagogy: gradual developmental phases (grammar/logic/rhetoric), contemplative memory work, and Socratic/seminar-based upper-level study.

Cited evidence: - “memorization, songs, chants and drills” and then “logical order ... articulate knowledge with skill, wisdom and eloquence.” - Lower-grade singing/memory; upper-grade Socratic discussions and rhetoric training. - Logic School curricular components (Omnibus, memory work, Latin, etc.).

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe teachers as mentors and note collaboration between teachers and parents, with a culture that emphasizes virtue, character, and the teacher-student relationship. However, explicit language about the faculty as “living curriculum,” or a formal “portrait of teachers” is less evident in the accessible materials. The collaboration between teachers and parents is clear, signaling a collaborative, mentoring environment but with less explicit articulation of the formal faculty archetype. - Several statements describe teachers and parents partnering for student formation, which aligns with a collegial, mentorship-oriented approach, but the explicit “living curriculum” or formal faculty portrait language is not overt in the materials provided. - There are explicit programmatic references to teacher-led, memory-based and seminar-based instruction, which implies strong teacher involvement, but without a clearly stated living-curriculum/faculty-profile framework in the public materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: teacher, mentor, partnership, collaboration, collegial (implied), guidance, formation of character. - Negative keywords observed: none explicitly,

but the key “living curriculum” and explicit faculty portrait language is not clearly stated in public materials.

How this rating was determined - The school demonstrates substantial teacher involvement and a collaborative approach with parents, which aligns with classical ideals for faculty, but the absence of explicit phrases like “living curriculum,” “model teachers,” or a formal faculty portrait reduces the strength to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: - Partnership between teachers and parents; collaborative ethos. - Curriculum and pedagogy references involving teachers’ roles (memory work, Socratic discussions).

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize partnership with families and parental involvement as co-educators, with explicit language about assisting parents in covenantal education and aligning with biblical perspectives. The Principal’s Pamphlet and Philosophy of Education sections underscore ongoing family engagement, parent gatherings, and catechesis for parents. - There are references to parent involvement through devotions, chapels, and all-school events; the school invites parental engagement, visits, and participation in the educational process. - The school explicitly frames parents as co-educators and emphasizes training parents via resources and gatherings to understand classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, parent formation, parental involvement. - Negative keywords observed: none.

How this rating was determined - The public materials strongly foreground parent partnership and family engagement, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: - “At Providence Christian Academy, our mission is to assist parents in the covenantal education of their children” and “parents as co-teachers with the school.” - “The teachers and parents partner together for the good of the children.”

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 5 (Faculty): Publicly articulate and publish a concrete “faculty profile” or “living-curriculum” description that names model-teachers, mentors, and the core of the school as a living curriculum. Explicit language about teacher portraits and the living curriculum would strengthen the Faculty signal to CLASSICAL. Consider adding a page or section detailing teacher formation, mentorship, professional norms, and how faculty embody the virtues and classical ideals in daily practice.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Include explicit statements about collegiality, collaborative professional development, and how faculty act as living examples of virtue and character to students.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Continue and expand parent education initiatives (book studies, lectures, workshops) to further formalize parents’ role as co-educators and deepen the “formation of affections” within families. This would cement Element 6 as a stronger CLASSICAL signal rather than merely CLASSIC.

Note: The above needle-moving steps would primarily fortify Element 5 and Element 6 signals, nudging Element 5 closer to CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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